

Across

- 1 USA's keeper of secrets, including flirtations with other nation states. (3)
- 4 Slang indicating that you're just joking. (3)
- 7 The kind of cheekiness you don't want to receive from your Valentine. (4)
- 8 De-____, what you may need to spray on your windshield on the harshest winter mornings. (4)
- 10 The kind of specs you may view your romantic partner with today, or that Tom Thibodeau views a particular point guard with. (4-7)
- 13 The occasion for many of today's gifts, dates, and crossword themes. (13)
- 15 What you must do with your shot, if you want a chance at scoring points or a date. (5)
- 16 The kind of game you don't want to throw in your love life, but you do want your favorite team's pitcher to toss. (2-3)
- 17 Briefly, the month when many new year's conceptions reach birth. (3)
- 18 Briefly, the team whose fans have plenty of Young love. (3)
- 19 You'd rather hear yesses than these in response to your Valentine's entreaties. (3)
- 20 Text slang for deceased, perhaps used after getting shut down by the opposite sex. (3)
- 22 With enough grinding, NBA 2K players can earn the gym-__ rat badge for their hard working players. (3)

- 23 A *two* or *three* is not this part of speech when describing a basketball shot, but is when counting All-Star appearances, MVPs, or titles won. (7)
- 26 First name of the player who proposed changing his last name from "Granger" to "Stern's B*tch" after the league nixed the Chris Paul/Lakers trade in 2011. (5)
- 27 K-Pop hunks dominating American pop like the second coming of NSYNC. (3)

Down

- 1 Before it goes cold, how you might describe an investigation into a freshly unsolved crime. (8)
- 2 Quick answer in the affirmative when asked if you emailed something already. (5)
- 3 No Clue
- 4 Furnace one might fire up to finish a clay or ceramic masterpiece for their crush. (4)
- 5 You may refer to either Joel or Ethan as this kind of brother or director. (5)
- 6 Private or discreet information about oneself, such as dating status. (8)
- 7 You may boast if you conquered a video game or musical composition in this fashion, but not if you completed Valentine's Day in the same sense by virtue of being alone. (6)
- 9 How you might describe a single piece of spicy cinnamon candy, or a relationship at the peak of romantic energy. (3,3)
- 10 Two of these make for a spirited, if hokey, kind of speech from a coach at half time. (4)
- 11 Players may apply these to ailing body parts; lovers may apply elsewhere. (9)
- 12 Record label featuring

- Cold Showers, Death of Lovers, Pierce with Arrow, VR SEX, and other alt-romantic artist titles. (4)
- 13 It takes a lot more work to get these kind of cuts on your body than it does to perform them on the court. (2)
- 14 Abbreviation for the site where you may watch playlists full of advice from pickup artists or comedy from pickup pranksters. (2)
- 21 How you don't want your all-out V Day plan to be described. (3)
- 22 Allen who was one of the first to claim he was hacked on Twitter after a very NSFW tweet (which read like a DM) was sent from his handle. (3)
- 24 Queen of the fairies, who Mercutio suspected of filling Romeo's dreams with dangerous desires. (3)
- 25 Many have more fond relationship with these than they do with their DRs. (3)

